

Engineer Onboarding Guide — Platform Engineering / SRE

Section 1 — Administrative Privileges Requirement

Objective

Determine whether the engineer requires local Windows Administrator privileges for development or platform tooling installation.

Policy

Local Administrator access must only be granted when explicitly required for:

- Development tools installation
- Container runtime installation
- VPN or network tooling
- Virtualization software
- Build tooling requiring elevated privileges

If admin privileges are not required, the user must remain a standard Windows user.

Action Items

Step 1.1 — Validate Requirement

Manager or onboarding coordinator must confirm:

- Which tools require elevation
- Whether admin rights are temporary or permanent

Step 1.2 — Add User to Local Administrators Group

If approved:

- Add the Windows user account to the local Administrators group on the assigned workstation.

Step 1.3 — Verification

Engineer should verify:

- Ability to install approved tooling
 - Elevated command prompt access
 - No unnecessary privilege escalation
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Section 2 — Active Directory (AD) UID Creation

Objective

Ensure the engineer has a valid Active Directory (AD) account and UID.

Required Outcome

The engineer must receive:

- Corporate AD account
 - AD UID
 - Corporate email mapping
 - Authentication access for enterprise systems
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Action Items

Step 2.1 — Raise AD Account Request

Submit request through the internal IT onboarding process.

Step 2.2 — Verify Account Activation

Engineer must confirm:

- AD login works
- Password reset works
- MFA enrollment is completed

Step 2.3 — Capture UID Information

Store the following onboarding metadata:

- Employee Name

- AD UID
- Email ID
- Team Name
- Manager Name
- Joining Date

Section 3 — Active Directory Group Memberships

Objective

Add the engineer to all required AD groups for Platform Engineering and SRE responsibilities.

Required AD Groups

The engineer must be added to the following groups:

Group Name	Purpose
Platform Engineering - SRE	Primary SRE organization access
PlatformEngineering-SRE-SG	Security group for SRE tooling
SNOW-AssignmentGroup-DevOps-PROD	ServiceNow PROD assignment access
SNOW-AssignmentGroup-DevOps-UAT	ServiceNow UAT assignment access
SNOW-Role-ITIL-Prod	ITIL role permissions
SNOW-Role-ReportGroup-Prod	Reporting permissions
Domain Users	Standard domain access
Bitbucket Users	Bitbucket repository access
DevOpsEngineering	DevOps engineering permissions
Elasticsearch-Admins	Elasticsearch administration

Group Name	Purpose
grafana-admin	Grafana administrative access
Grafana-editors	Grafana dashboard editing
SADeploymentApprovers	Deployment approval permissions
SRE Notifications	SRE notification distribution
SRE Notifications - Global	Global SRE notifications
SREComms	SRE communication channels

Validation Procedure

Step 3.1 — Group Addition Request

Submit access request for all required AD groups.

Step 3.2 — Propagation Wait Time

Allow AD synchronization and propagation to complete:

- Typical delay: 15 minutes to 4 hours
- In some environments: next login required

Step 3.3 — Reauthentication

Engineer should:

- Log out and log back in
- Reconnect VPN if applicable
- Refresh browser sessions

Step 3.4 — Verification Checklist

Verify:

- AD groups appear in user profile
- SSO authentication succeeds
- Access errors are not present

Section 4 — Tool Access Verification

Objective

Verify the engineer can successfully access all required engineering platforms after AD group membership is completed.

Important Dependency

This section must only begin after:

- AD UID creation is complete
 - All AD groups from Section 3 are added
 - Access propagation is completed
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Required URL Access Validation

The engineer must verify access to the following systems.

Jenkins (Primary)

Purpose:

- CI/CD pipelines
- Build execution
- Deployment automation

Access URL:

<https://jenkins.domain.com/>

Validation:

- Login succeeds via SSO or AD authentication
- Dashboard loads successfully
- User can view assigned jobs

Jenkins (SSV)

Purpose:

- Secondary Jenkins environment
- Specialized pipeline execution

Access URL:

<https://ssv-jenkins.domain.com/>

Validation:

- Login succeeds
- Build visibility is available
- No authorization errors

ArgoCD

Purpose:

- Kubernetes GitOps deployment management

Access URL:

<https://argocd.adc-ss.domain.com/>

Validation:

- Application dashboard loads
- User can view clusters/applications
- RBAC permissions are correct

Bitbucket

Purpose:

- Source code repository management

Access URL:

<https://bitbucket.domain.com/>

Validation:

- Repository visibility works
 - Git clone permissions function
 - Pull request access is available
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OpenSearch / Log Dashboard

Purpose:

- Centralized logging and observability

Access URL:

<https://mylogs.domain.com/app/home>

Validation:

- Dashboard opens successfully
 - Logs are searchable
 - No permission-denied messages
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Spinnaker

Purpose:

- Continuous delivery orchestration

Access URL:

<https://spinnaker.domain.com/>

Validation:

- Pipelines are visible
 - Applications load successfully
 - User authorization is correct
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Grafana

Purpose:

- Monitoring dashboards and alert visualization

Access URL:

<https://grafana.domain.com/>

Validation:

- Login succeeds
 - Dashboards are accessible
 - Editor/admin permissions match assigned role
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Section 5 — Final Onboarding Validation

Completion Checklist

Validation Item	Status
Windows admin access reviewed	Pending / Completed
AD UID created	Pending / Completed
MFA configured	Pending / Completed
Required AD groups added	Pending / Completed
Jenkins access verified	Pending / Completed
ArgoCD access verified	Pending / Completed
Bitbucket access verified	Pending / Completed
OpenSearch access verified	Pending / Completed
Spinnaker access verified	Pending / Completed
Grafana access verified	Pending / Completed

Section 6 — Escalation Path

If Access Fails

The engineer should provide:

- Screenshot of the error
- Timestamp
- URL accessed
- AD UID
- VPN status
- Browser used

Contact Teams

Issue Type	Contact Team
AD Account Issues	Identity & Access Management
Group Membership Issues	Platform Engineering
Jenkins Issues	DevOps Platform Team
Grafana / Logging Issues	Observability Team
Bitbucket Issues	SCM Administration
VPN / Network Issues	Enterprise IT Support

Metadata for RAG Systems

Keywords

Platform Engineering, SRE, onboarding, AD groups, Jenkins access, Grafana access, Bitbucket onboarding, ArgoCD access, Spinnaker onboarding, Elasticsearch admins, DevOps onboarding, ServiceNow roles, Active Directory onboarding

Recommended Chunking Strategy for LLM Indexing

Suggested chunk boundaries:

1. Windows Admin Access
2. AD UID Creation
3. AD Group Memberships
4. Jenkins Access
5. ArgoCD Access
6. Bitbucket Access
7. Grafana Access
8. Troubleshooting
9. Final Validation Checklist

This improves retrieval accuracy for chatbot-based onboarding support.